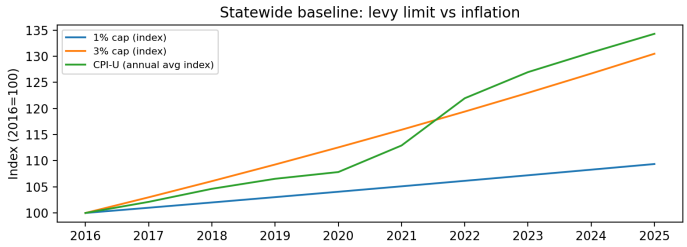
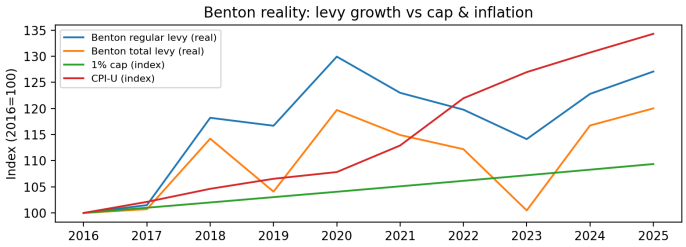
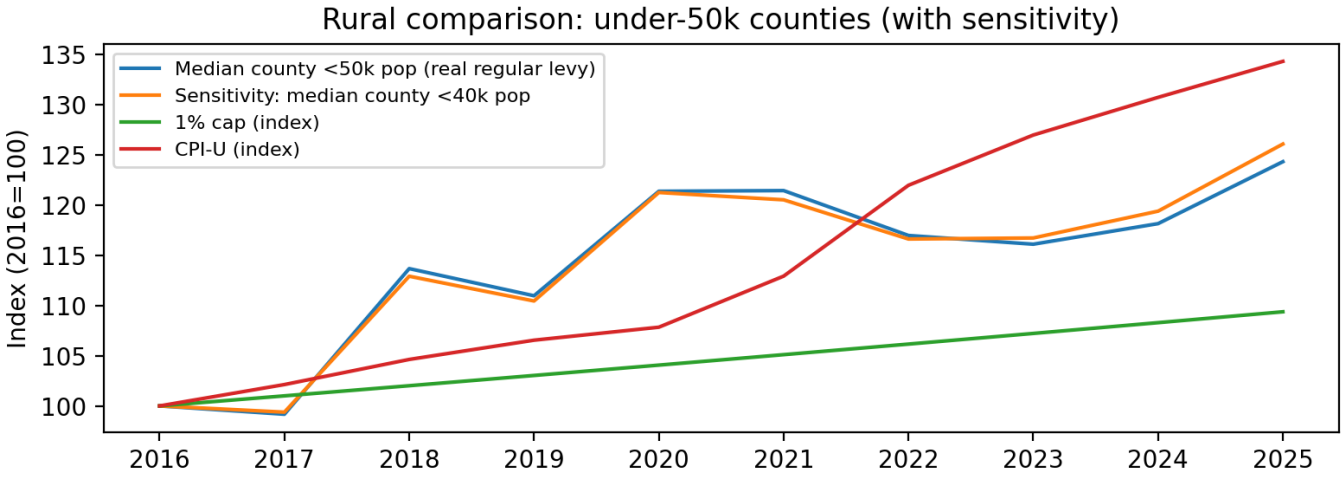
WA 1% Levy Limit vs Inflation: Benton Reality + Rural Counties <50k (Sensitivity)

Three-layer view: (1) statewide mechanics (cap vs CPI), (2) Benton levy history (regular + total), (3) rural county comparison using OFM county p







Key takeaways (for briefing)

- 1% cap (101% limit) is a nominal growth ceiling; CPI has often exceeded 1%, implying real purchasing power erosion unless lifts/new constru
- Benton: regular levy and total levy move differently because excess/voted levies (and state/local mix) change independently of the 101% ceil
- Rural set definition: counties with 2025 OFM April 1 population < 50,000 (18 counties).
- Borderline sensitivity: WA has no counties between 50k–55k in 2025 OFM; widening threshold to <40k still yields a very similar median trajec
- Next layer (if you want it): add per-capita and per-$1,000 AV rates once we pull countywide AV totals from WA DOR statistics tables.

Sources: WA DOR Property Tax Statistics (Local levy detail / All County Levy Detail files, 2016–2025); WA OFM April 1 population estimates (2020–2025); CPI annual averag